TRANSFORMING CUSTOMER JOURNEYS
Playbook

Talent

Retention, career progression career management

This playbook contains all the pieces and parts that make up our approach to transforming customer journeys. This is a living document and the latest version can be found on TCJ's Confluence site.

Last updated in May 2019

CIMB

How this module fits into overall TCJ Playbook

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How do we retain and excite our talent?

Principles of agile career

Approach to agile career

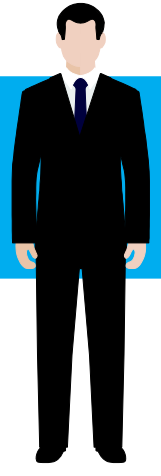
- Career tracks
- Competency model
- Evaluation model
- Remuneration model

Examples of best in class agile careers

What is the new attitude to career path?

How we talk about career traditionally

" I started as a junior analyst in company x, then I was a senior analyst in company y, then I became a manager in company z etc."



Title is the most important thing

How 3D talents talk about career

" I was working on product x at company n, then I launched product y at company m, then I led product z at … etc. "

What you do is what really matters

A set of guiding principles that can be used to define the Agile career model

Expertise should be praised	▪ Experts are **compensated at the same level as management** ▪ In-depth subject experts can **continue within their respective sub-tracks and also move across sub-tracks** on the basis of a defined set of criteria
Flexible career path	▪ Clear **guidelines are defined for how to progress or move across career paths** ▪ A minimum **rank is required for roles with management** responsibility ▪ Opportunities to **move across different specialties on the basis of set criteria**
Relevant training and certification	▪ Relevant **certifications and training courses** are defined for specific titles ▪ **Leadership / management training is given early** in people's careers
Focus on talent	▪ **Fast career progression is possible** for top talents ▪ Package for high demand / rare skills can be differentiated (if needed) ▪ Graduates will enter a dedicated training and rotation program allowing them to experience multiple roles within IT
Unbundling career ladder	▪ **Don't try to fit all criteria into single career ladder -** allow alternative career paths ▪ Decentralized management of some career tracks – not only HR

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Agile teams find multiple issues with the traditional view of “single career path”

Traditional career ladder

Key features

- Single career path for all
- All factors contribute to single career formula defining grade: span of control, expertise, tenure etc.
- Grade defines compensation level
- 10-20+ Grades
- Strong focus on managerial role

Key problems

- Inability to retain true top talents not willing to do management work
- Loss of value due to conversion of great experts (e.g. engineers) into mediocre managers
- Poor transparency of various talent development dimensions (expertise, product/project, non-official positions)
- Limited space to Grow = low motivation
- High complexity and lack of understanding of career decisions

As with other agile units, TCJ members follow one of many career tracks

ILLUSTRATIVE; NOT COMPREHENSIVE

Career tracks

→ Progressions within each career track

Technology Track	Junior Engineer (S)	Engineer (S)	Senior Engineer (S)	Expert Engineer (S)	Master Engineer (S)
People Development Track		Chapter Lead (CL)	Senior Chapter Lead (CL)	Expert CL / Chapter Area Lead (CL, CAL)	Master CL / Senior CAL** (CL, CAL)
Business Ownership Track		Product Owner (PO)	Senior Product Owner (PO)	Expert PO / Journey Lead (PO, JL)	Master PO / Senior JL*** (PO, JL)

Employees can be assigned and re-assigned to any track at any time throughout career at TCJ

1Rigid adherence to rules or processes; 2 Capable of structuring his or her work and self-learning; 3 Capable of self-structuring and takes part in advanced training; 4 Recognized expert in his / her field, provides training to other employees, takes part in conferences; 5 Leading professional in his/her field worldwide, acts as speaker at conferences

SOURCE: Sanitized client example

Seniority is based on competence levels, not on number of direct reports

ILLUSTRATIVE; NOT COMPREHENSIVE

Career tracks	Competence Level (based on acquisition of a defined set of skill-sets)				
	Novice[1]	Advanced Beginner[2]	Competent[3]	Proficient[4]	Master[5]
	L1 L2 L3	L4 L5 L6	L7 L8 L9	L10 L11 L12	L13 L14 L15
Technology Track	S Junior Engineer	S Engineer	S Senior Engineer	S Expert Engineer	S Master Engineer
People Development Track		CL Chapter Lead	CL Senior Chapter Lead	CL CAL Expert CL / Chapter Area Lead	CL CAL Master CL / Senior CAL**
Business Ownership Track		PO Product Owner	PO Senior Product Owner	PO JL Expert PO / Journey Lead	PO JL Master PO / Senior JL***

Positions are not limited; you can be assigned additional responsibilities whenever you deserve it.
TCJ's people model is focused on promoting expertise growth

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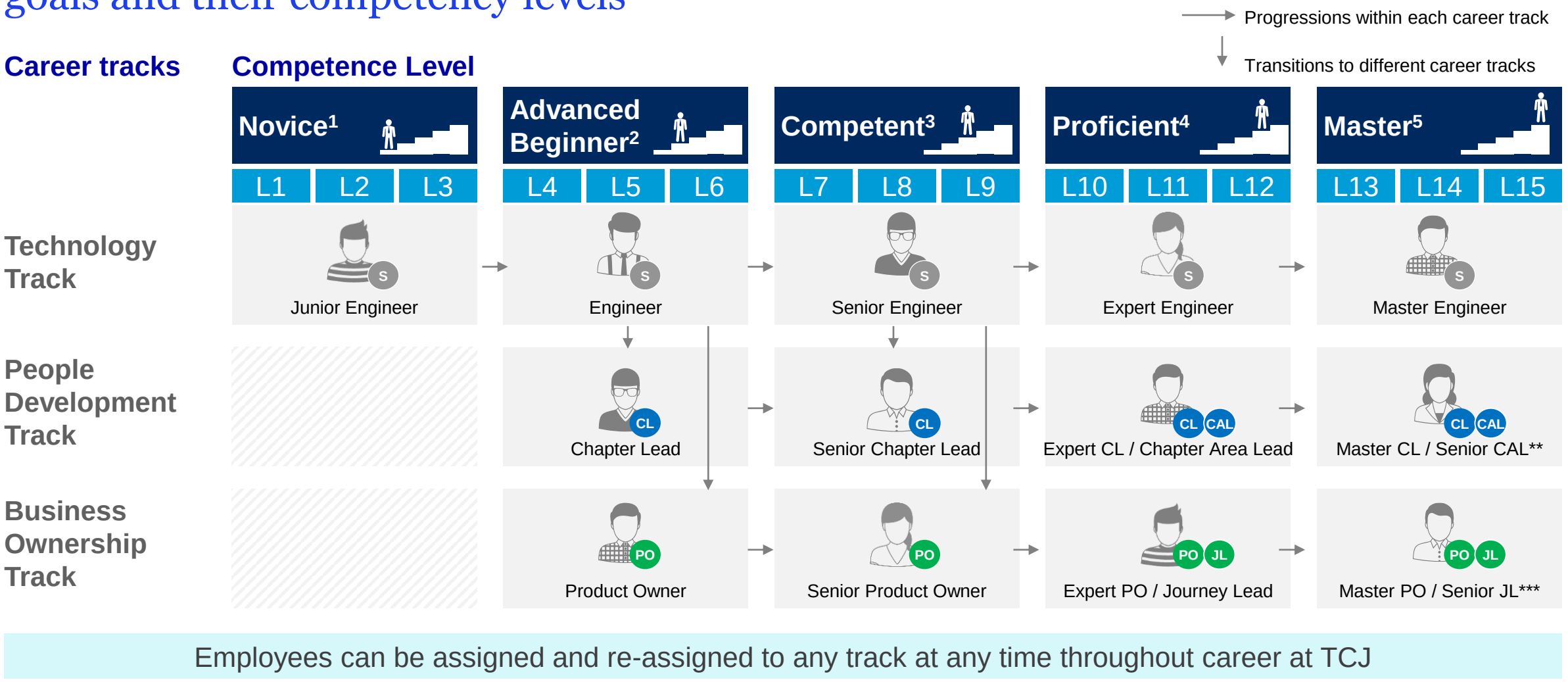
SOURCE: Sanitized client example

TCJ members can change career tracks based on personal development goals and their competency levels

ILLUSTRATIVE; NOT COMPREHENSIVE



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Evaluations are done against defined competence levels – based on skill acquisition

		1. Beginner	2. Advanced Beginner	3. Competent	4. Accomplished	5. Expert
Competence level		L1 L2 L3	L4 L5 L6	L7 L8 L9	L10 L11 L12	L13 L14 L15
		Rigid adherence to rules or processes	Capable of structuring his or her work and self-learning	Capable of self-structuring and takes part in advanced training	Recognized expert in his / her field, provides training to other employees, takes part in conferences	Leading professional in his/her field worldwide, acts as speaker at conferences
Analogy		**Can buy the right ingredients from a recipe** *(Limited ingredients, starting to learn simple techniques)*	**Can cook a meal using a recipe** *(Able to support others, still with some guidance / instruction)*	**Can host a dinner party for friends with multiple courses** *(Can multi-task cooking, hosting – often using more adventurous ingredients to showcase ability)*	**Can run a kitchen staffed with competent cooks** *(Advanced meals, limited ingredients, simple techniques)*	**Creates innovative new dishes and writes the recipe book for others to follow** *(Invents new cooking techniques)*
Skill sets	Values and behaviours	▪ I live the values to grow and develop myself to deliver on the squad purpose	▪ I live the values to grow and develop both myself and our squad to deliver on our purpose and to make us successful	▪ I live the values to grow and develop myself to be a powerful contributor within/outside own squad to make our tribe successful	▪ I live the values to grow and develop myself to be a powerful contributor within/outside own tribe to make company successful	▪ I live and actively promote the values to grow and develop myself as a widely recognizeed contributor to success of the company and my field
	Technical capabilities (Further detailed by chapter e.g. UX)	▪ I need careful instructions to deliver great results ▪ I require guidance to achieve successful delivery	▪ I use independent judgement to deliver great results and improve my T-shaped profile ▪ I require some guidance to achieve successful delivery	▪ I deliver great results independently and tailor my T-shaped profile ▪ I guide and support my junior colleagues in my field	▪ I impact and shape the delivery with my experience ▪ I guide and support all my chapter colleagues to ensure a successful delivery	▪ I convey my insights as a thought leader and have a great impact on the delivery ▪ I contribute to the development of my field in the worldwide community
	Aqile ways of working	▪ I am aware of the agile w-o-w principles ▪ I need guidance to work in agile organization	▪ I fully understand the agile w-o-w principles ▪ I work successfully in agile organization	▪ I excel in working in an agile organization ▪ I can guide colleagues in the agile w-o-w	▪ I focus on guiding colleagues in the agile w-o-w ▪ I strive to improve squad's agile cycle to be even more successful	▪ I strive to improve tribe's agile cycle to be even more successful ▪ I network externally to get the best insights to develop Agile w-o-w
	Team member	▪ I share knowledge with my squad colleagues ▪ I actively team up and collaborate to improve delivery	▪ I actively help my team improve ▪ I actively team up and collaborate with other squads to help them	▪ I drive within-squad team building ▪ I actively team up and collaborate with other squads and chapters to improve delivery	▪ I drive community building in tribe / chapter ▪ I actively team up and collaborate within internal and external network to improve delivery	▪ I radiate expertise by driving organization-level
	Business capabilities	▪ I know our customer vision ▪ I consider daily how my actions benefit the customer	▪ I take our customer vision into account in my actions ▪ I evaluate daily how my actions benefit the customer and define improvements	▪ I consider the customer in my every action ▪ I strive to bring in knowledge on customer solutions from my network	▪ I coach and guide my squad colleagues on customer vision adoption ▪ I ensure that our squad backlog is 100% customer vision proof (each item takes us closer to the vision)	▪ I bring to the company the latest thought leadership on customer solutions in my field ▪ I guide tribe to evaluate that their backlog is 100% customer vision proof (each item takes us closer to the vision)

Each career track would involve a different set of skill sets; with further differentiation for specialized roles

Jobs performed by employees at each competence level

	1. Beginner	2. Advanced Beginner	3. Competent	4. Accomplished	5. Expert
Competence level	L1 L2 L3	L4 L5 L6	L7 L8 L9	L10 L11 L12	L13 L14 L15
	Rigid adherence to rules or processes	Capable of structuring his or her work and self-learning	Capable of self-structuring and takes part in advanced training	Recognized expert in his / her field, provides training to other employees, takes part in conferences	Leading professional in his/her field worldwide, acts as speaker at conferences
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Job complexity and scope	▪ **Works on tasks which have a defined process**. Has no role in decision-making, and has no scope to apply judgement		▪ **Works on moderately challenging tasks**, which require judgement and experience in making decisions or making recommendations to others		▪ **Resolves highly complex issues by using initiative and experience.** Makes recommendations on approaches to tasks for others to follow
Supervision	▪ **Works under close supervision** and requires detailed instructions for all work		▪ **Usually requires little instruction**, and will look for only high level direction on new tasks if needed		▪ **Full autonomy to determine approach to tasks**. Acts as a role model to others, and provides technical direction where needed.
Experience	▪ Less than one year of relevant experience	▪ Typically requires a minimum of 1-2 years of relevant experience	▪ Typically requires a minimum of 2-4 years of relevant experience	▪ Typically requires a minimum of 4-6 years of relevant experience	▪ Typically requires a minimum of 6+ years of relevant experience

Examples – What do members in different tracks do from day-to-day?

	Novice[1]	Advanced Beginner[2]	Competent[3]	Proficient[4]	Master[5]
Technology Track	**"Home buying" Senior Customer Journey Expert[6]** (S)	▪ Works in **one squad 100%** ▪ Creates **fast** and **easy "Product application"** experience together with engineers in his squad ▪ **Coaches junior colleagues** on "Home journey" specifics **(content)**		**"Home buying" Master Customer Journey Expert** (S)	▪ Works in **one or more squads 100%** ▪ **The "go-to" person** on the "Home journey": used to be a **multi-million real-estate entrepreneur** ▪ **Significant authority** without **any reports, guest speaker** on **RE events**
People Develop-ment Track	**Senior "UX/CX" Chapter Lead** (CL)	▪ **Creative** genius, works as a **designer CJE** in **one squad 70%** ▪ Additionally responsible **(30%)** for the **"how" / people mgt.** of his chapter: — Setting **style guidelines** across journeys and **QA** — **Coaching, training, evaluation**		**Senior "Risk, Fraud and Compliance" CAL** (CAL)	▪ **Seasoned employee**, been with us for **last 20 years** after doing a **PhD** in **Corporate Law (cum laude)** ▪ **Not part of a squad**, but **enforces compliance** standards across multiple **chapters** and **squads** ▪ Puts her **people** to the **right place**
Business Ownership Track	**"Mortgage advice" Senior Product Owner** (PO)	▪ **Senior Customer Journey Expert** for Product advice (30-70%), started his path as a **branch advisor**) ▪ Responsible to lead the **"what"** of her squad (30-70%) — **Backlog management** — **Day-to-day prioritization**		**"Home buying" Tribe Lead** (TL)	▪ **"Captain"** of the "Home Journey" tribe: earlier responsible for **"Mortgage" P&L** ▪ Knows the **"Home journeys" by heart**, has **instinct** for **business value** and **customer experience** ▪ Widely **respected** and **followed** by POs **not** due to **position**, but **competence**

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SOURCE: Sanitized client example

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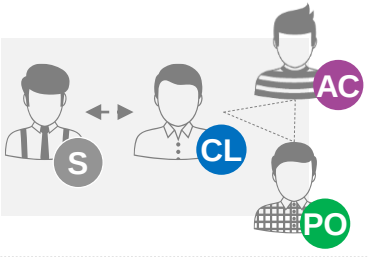
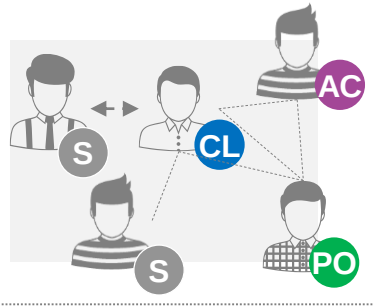
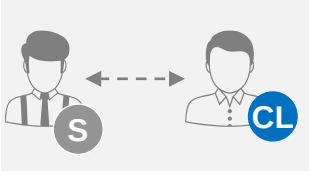
Examples of best in class agile careers

TCJ would use a 360-degree model during evaluation of its members

S Squad member · AC Agile coach / Scrum master · CL Chapter lead · PO Product owner / Journey lead

Frequency: High → Low

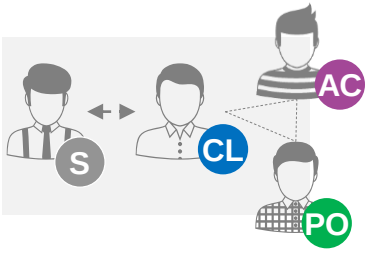
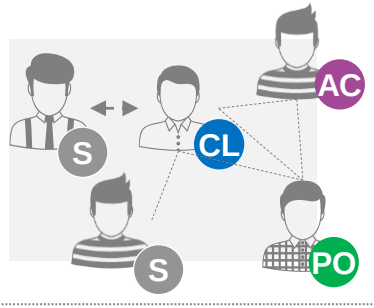
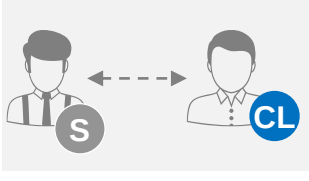
Evaluation mechanism	How does it work?	What do we get out of it?	Who provides feedback?
Continuous Feedback	• Continuous **dialogues** with **everyone you work with** and at least one **assigned mentor**[1]	• **Daily tips** on how to **best use your strengths**	• **At least one assigned mentor**[1] or anyone else
POCLAC Feedback 	• Summary from meeting of **PO, CL** and **AC,** where they discuss on how to make your squad **high-performing**	• Any feedback related to **contributing** to **high-performance** of your squad (e.g. training needs)	• **Chapter Lead,** through quick and informal catch-ups (not a set meeting)
Dialogue 	• **A reflection on last quarter** based on inputs of POCLACs and feedback from all co-workers, leading to eventual promotion	• **Progress indication** and tracking towards eventual promotion (no promotions) • **Personal development plan** outlining focus areas to enable or accelerate competence level advancement	• **Chapter Lead,** based on 360 degree inputs of POCLAC and co-workers • **Coworker input** is assembled with weight on specific skills and capabilities relevant for next competence level
Review 	• **A reflection on the year** based on inputs of POCLACs and feedback from all co-workers, leading to eventual promotion	• **Official competence level** and possible grade promotions • **Personal development plan** outlining focus areas to enable or accelerate competence level advancement	• **Chapter Lead,** based on inputs of POCLAC and co-workers

1 A person within the chapter with at least 1 level higher level of competence

SOURCE: Sanitized client example

A few models can be considered for evaluation, especially as TCJ ramps up

S Squad member | AC Agile coach / Scrum master | CL Chapter lead | PO Product owner / Journey lead

Frequency	Evaluation mechanism		Light	Medium	High
High	**Continuous Feedback**		✓ Daily	✓ Daily	✓ Daily
	POCLAC Feedback		✓ Quarterly (end of every Wave)	✓ Quarterly (end of every Wave)	✓ Biweekly (end of every sprint)
	Dialogue		✓ Yearly	✓ Biannually	✓ Quarterly
	Review			✓ Yearly	✓ Biannually
Low					

SOURCE: Sanitized client example

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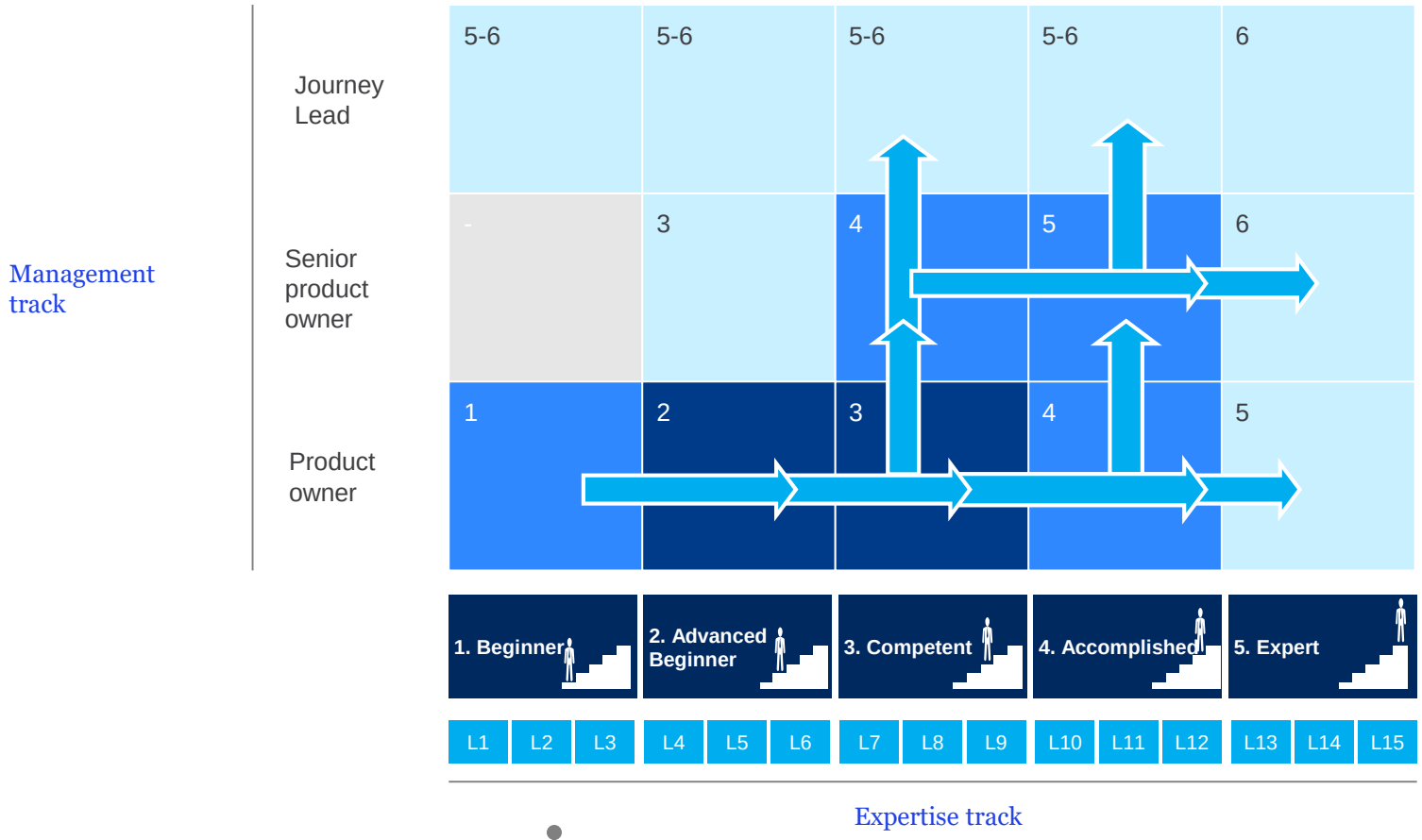
Examples of best in class agile careers

Salary bands and career progression are linked to career track and competency level

Example of compensation based on management role and level of expertise



3 salary levels per competency level

- Flexibility to reward employees and calibrate contracts to attract talent

Expected distribution of talents (from less expected to most expected areas)

Happy path - expected career move

X — Paygrade for the role; each paygrade may have a range of compensation based on performance

Description:

- Paygrade is a function of competency level and career track
  - **Higher competency level** rewarded with higher income as the basic rule (to reward growth)
  - Career track (similar to job family) also influences pay. For e.g., novice legal expert might be paid more than a Competent data analyst due to the market for that type of talent
- Distribution of members by paygrade: Majority of people expected to be at Competent level

Implications:

- Even a team member may be compensated at the level of a Journey Lead if he reaches Expert level
- Journey Lead's compensation is less dependent on level of expertise

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Spotify defines career growth by growth of sphere of influence

Steps framework defines career growth at Spotify based on growth of level of impact within the company

There is no link between steps framework and job titles, so an engineer can be od level 3 or 4

Compensation is influenced by steps. Compensation level between steps overlap a lot, so someone on Individual level can earn as much as on Chapter level

Manager can nominate his/her employee for a promotion based on consistent performance on the next level (not linked to performance review cycle)

Performance review dimensions

- Values team success over individual success
- Continuously improves themselves and their team
- Holds themselves and others accountable
- Thinks about the business impact of their work
- Demonstrates mastery of their discipline

SOURCE: Spotify blog: https://labs.spotify.com/2016/02/15/spotify-technology-career-steps/

Netflix uses the Dreyfus model for its engineering expertise track

I Novice	II Advanced Beginner	III Competent	IV Proficient	V Expert
▪ Graduate or junior in the role ▪ Performs tasks following context-free rules	▪ Autonomy to address similar problems ▪ Contextual understanding ▪ Decisions for standard situations	▪ Can solve new problems ▪ Conceptual understanding ▪ Active decision making	▪ Big picture, systems thinking ▪ Addresses important aspects, ignores irrelevant ones ▪ Deep understanding of rules, theories, alternatives	▪ Intuition, tacit knowledge ▪ Vision of what is possible, innovates ▪ Experts are not supercharged novices

- We value craftsmanship and competencies in building a high performing engineering workforce
- Netflix leverage the existing proven model of skill acquisition (Dreyfus), which includes:
  - defining observable skills, behaviors and generic competencies
  - on five maturity levels
  - for three IT profiles: Engineering, Feature Engineering and Architecture

Technology companies build equally important career path for experts and management

Engineers grow from level 2 to level 10, where 2 is new-joiner from a university and 10 is top expert (5-10) employees out of 40,000

At level 5 employee should make a decision whether to continue developing as an expert or become a manager

Compensation on the same level of expert and management track is about the same

Performance assessment happen twice a year at a people committee. Employee's manager present his/her case based on 360 feedback and interviews with employees colleagues. Assessment is done in a structured ways based on "6 pillars"

In order to be promoted an employee should perform at the next level for 6 months. Promotion decision can be made at people committee twice a year

BACKUP

Salary bands depend on competence level, local market conditions and chapter, not by role played (e.g. PO) in the organization - example

Competency sub-level

LX

Competence level	Salary level
Novice[1]	L1 L2 L3
Advanced Beginner[2]	L4 L5 L6
Competent[3]	L7 L8 L9
Proficient[4]	L10 L11 L12
Master[5]	L13 L14 L15

Features of the model

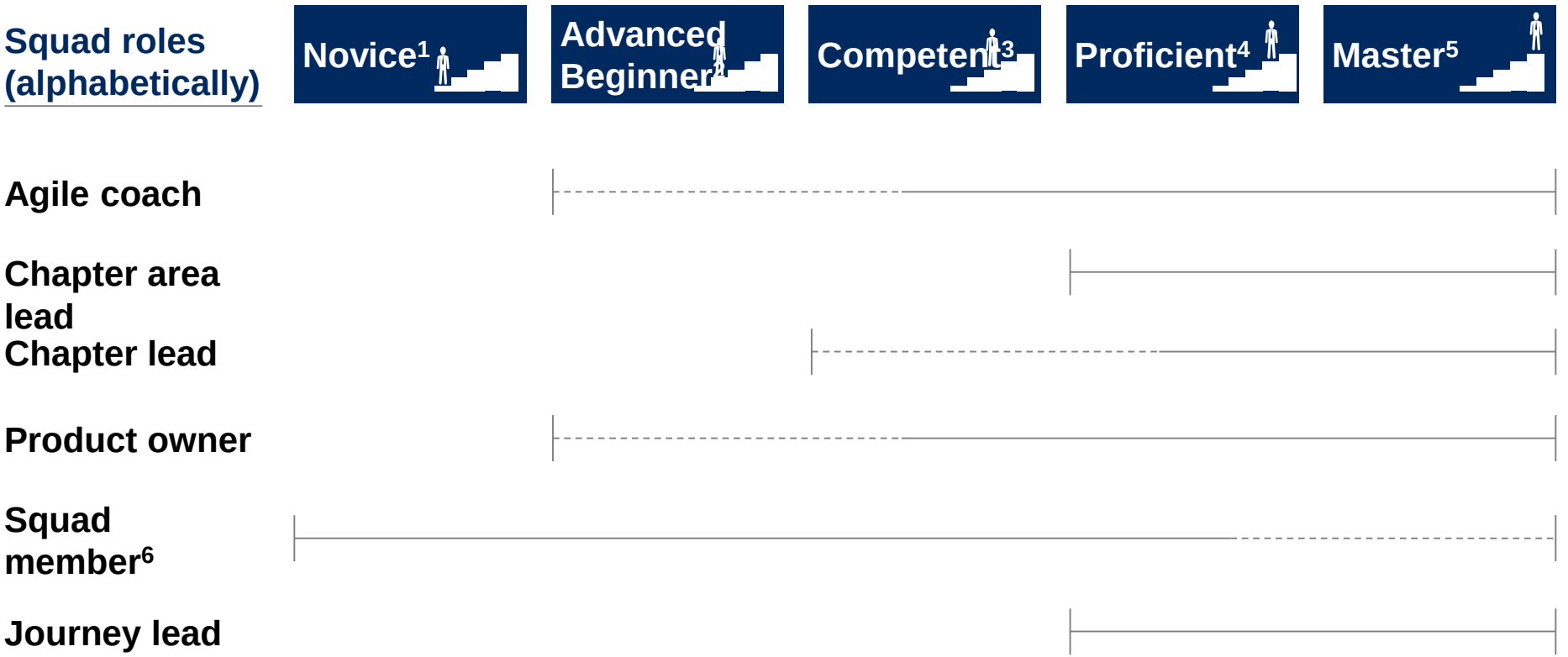
3 salary levels per competency level

- Flexibility to reward employees and calibrate contracts to attract talent

Total salary is a function of competency level, local market and chapter

- Higher competency level rewarded with higher income as the basic rule (to reward growth)
- Local market conditions dictate basic salary levels we need to pay (to create fairness)
- Chapter (job family) also influences pay – Novice legal expert might be paid more than a Competent data analyst due to the market for that type of talen

The role that each individual plays in a Journey Team and Squad is decoupled from conventional hierarchy



- Each role can be filled by any squad members
- Conversely, members of different competency levels can be assigned
- Typically, As TCJ members advance in their capabilities, they are expected to take additional roles (e.g., become PO or CL) in order to grow further

- TCJ members are assigned to those types of roles to utilize their skills

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* Customer Journey Expert ** – Chapter Area Lead *** - Tribe Lead

SOURCE: Sanitized client example